4 YEAR TERMS AUSTRALIA

4YearTerms.au

Committee Secretary
Joint Standing Committee on Electoral Matters
sent via: em@aph.gov.au

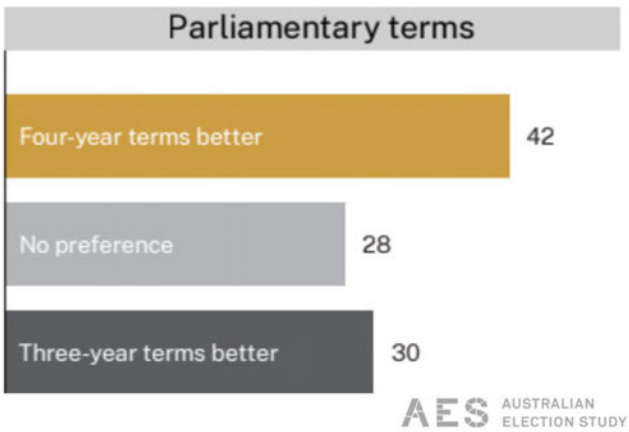
Supplementary submission - response to request for information

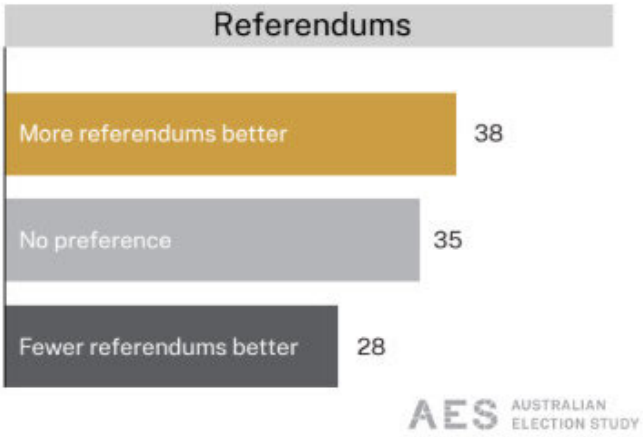
Thank you for having 4 Year Terms Australia appear at a public hearing for the Committee's Inquiry into the 2025 Federal Election. Please find below additional information requested from the Committee regarding public sentiment on parliamentary term lengths and fixed terms.

Survey data on four-year federal parliamentary terms

The Australian Election Study released in November 2025 found that 42% of voters prefer a four-year term compared to only 30% for our current three-year term. The remaining 28% of voters don't have a preference. The study also shows there is support for more referendums, which is required to extend federal parliamentary terms. It found that 38% of voters want more referendums, compared to only 28% who want fewer referendums.

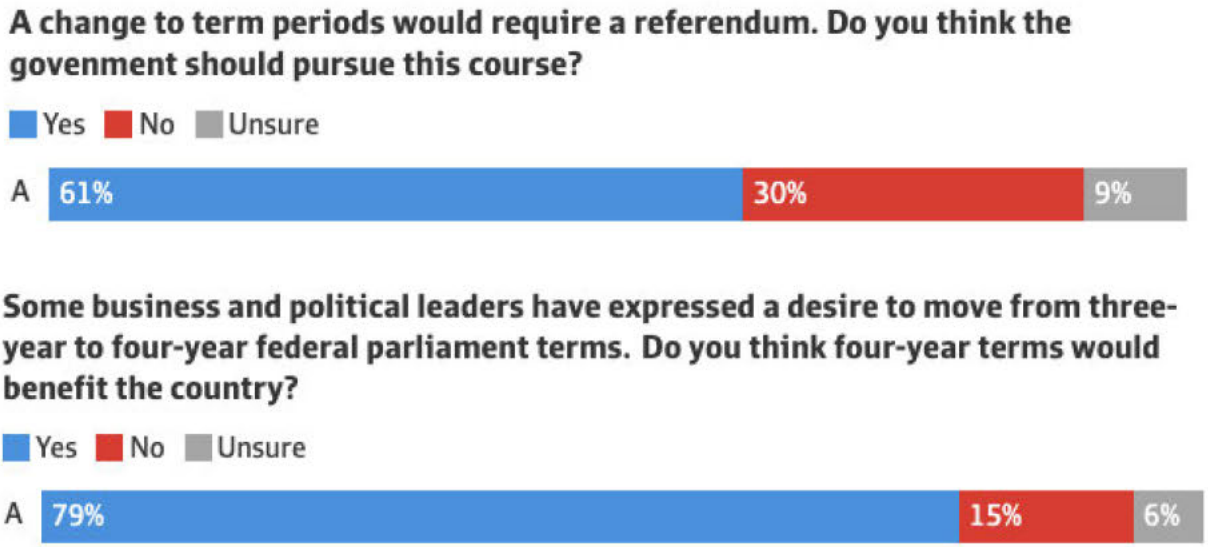
The Australian Election Study is the leading study of political attitudes and behaviour in Australia, run by the Australian National University and Griffith University. The study has surveyed voters since 1987 to provide independent analysis on voter trends across a range of topics.





Source: Griffith University and Australian National University, The Australian Election Study, 2025

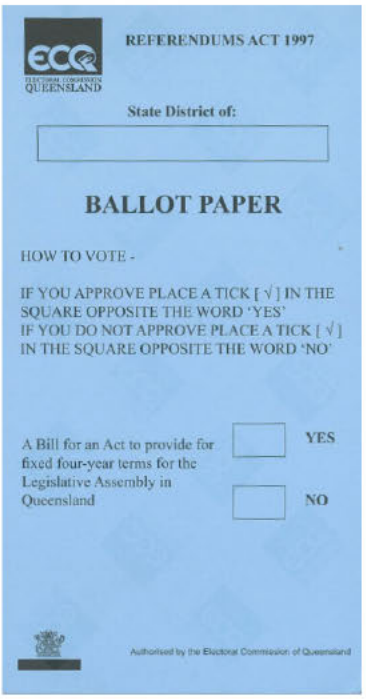
A study by the Australian Financial Review in 2024 also found that 80 per cent of its readership support increasing the length of the parliamentary term. In addition, more than 60 per cent of readers believe the Government of the time should pursue a referendum on the issue.

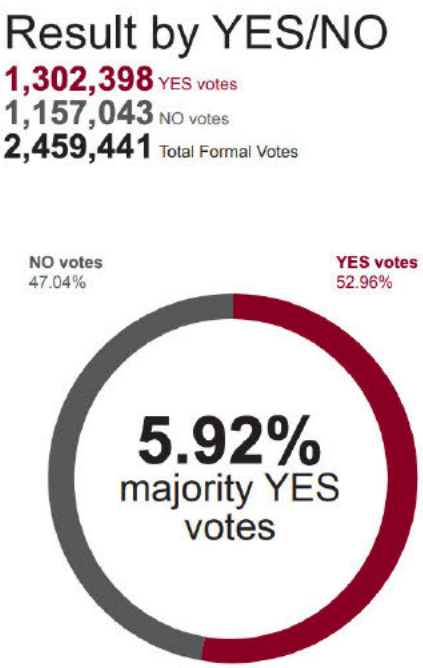


Source: The Australian Financial Review, Readership Poll, 2024

Queensland's 2016 referendum on fixed, four-year terms

In 2016 the Queensland Government held a referendum on extending its state parliament to fixed, four-year terms. The referendum was held in conjunction with local government elections. It successfully passed, with 52.96% of voters supporting the change to fixed, four-year terms.



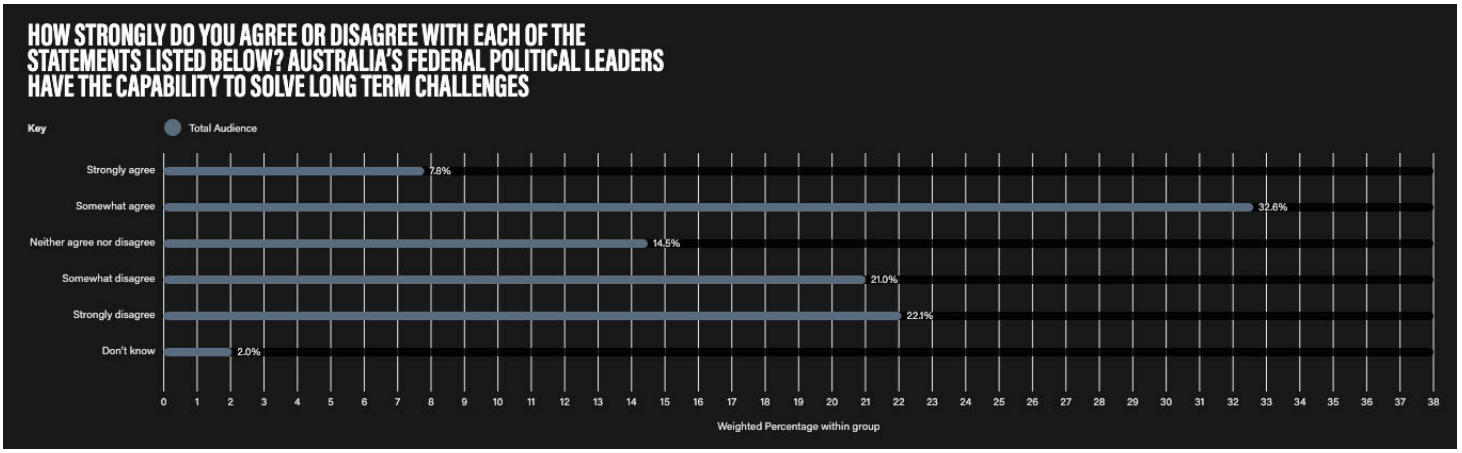


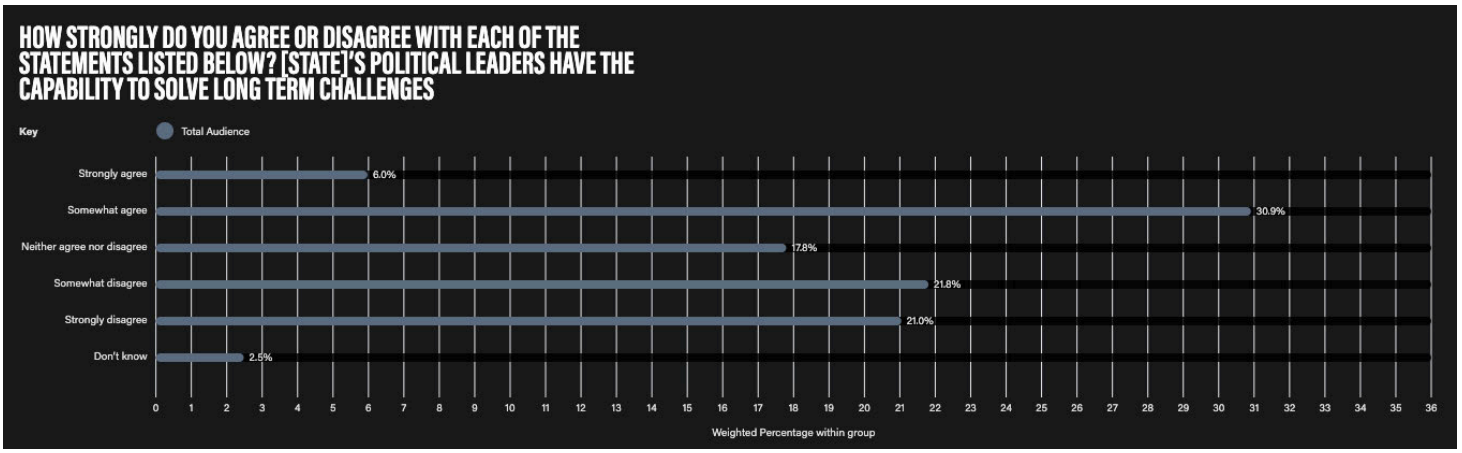
Source: Electoral Commission Queensland, Fixed Four-Year Terms Referendum Election Report, 2016

McKinnon Democracy Index 2025

The need for longer terms is further highlighted by the recently launched McKinnon Democracy Index. It found over half of Australians do not believe that federal politicians follow up and deliver on their commitments. Also 43% believed that federal politicians lack the capability to solve long-term challenges.

These findings come as the Federal Government has tasked a Parliamentary Inquiry with investigating parliamentary term lengths and the introduction of a fixed election date. A similar inquiry in New Zealand led to legislation being introduced this year to move to four-year terms, subject to a referendum.





Source: McKinnon, Democracy Index, 2025

Polling on New Zealand's proposed change to four-year terms

New Zealand is currently progressing the Term of Parliament (Enabling 4-Year Term) Bill, which would extend its maximum parliamentary term to four years, subject to a referendum. This Bill was introduced following a 2023 Independent Electoral Review, which recommended longer parliamentary terms to improve policy continuity and accountability.

In November 2020, a study by Research New Zealand found that 61 per cent of people wanted New Zealand's parliamentary term to be increased from three to four years. Similarly, a December 2020 ONE NEWS Colmar Brunton poll found that 60 percent of people supported extending the term to four years, with 36 percent saying no and the rest declining to answer. Polling from early 2025 by Horizon found that support for four year terms has a 10% lead over three year terms.

Thank you for the opportunity to contribute to this inquiry. If the Committee has any further questions or would like to discuss in further detail, please contact us at [redacted] or at 4yearterms.au

Sincerely,

Marty Gray
Founder
4 Year Terms Australia